

Computer and Information Technology

You picked an interest, not a career. Here is what that interest can turn into, and what to do first.

You can go all the way to a bachelor's degree in this pathway.

START	Certificates and your first courses Short, stackable, and employable on their own. CompTIA A+ is the usual first target.
NEXT	Associate degree (AAS) Two years. Everything you take counts toward the next step.
THEN	Bachelor of Applied Science in Information Technology 120 credits across eight terms. Phoenix College teaches the upper-division courses in this pathway.

Where this pathway leads

OCCUPATION	AZ MEDIAN
Computer and Information Systems Managers	\$151,490
Information Security Analysts	\$106,360
Computer Systems Analysts	\$105,510

Arizona annual median wages from the Maricopa BAS in Information Technology pathway map. Education requirements vary by occupation, so some of these need study beyond this degree. Talk to an advisor.

Your first term, from the pathway map

BPC170	A+ Exam Prep: Computer Hardware
CIS105	Survey of Computer Information Systems
CIS133DA	Internet and Web Development I
ENG101	First-Year Composition
FYE101	Introduction to College and Career
MAT	College Mathematics or higher

A suggested sequence, not a rule. Build your own plan with an advisor. You need a C or better in every program course.

Jobs you have probably never heard of

- **Site reliability engineer.** Keeps large systems running, and stays calm when they break.
- **Cloud cost engineer.** Finds the money a company wastes on cloud services.
- **Security operations analyst.** Decides which alerts are real attacks, then runs the response.
- **Data engineer.** Builds the pipes that carry data to the people analyzing it.
- **Solutions architect.** Designs what gets built, sitting between customer and engineers.

Get involved from week one

- **Computer Science Club.** Mondays at noon, E-223.
- **PC Business Club.** Tuesdays at 1:00, B-317.
- **Bear's Den.** The college pitch competition, for anyone building something of their own.
- **Campus student worker roles.** Paid, on campus, and directly industry-relevant.

Five things to do in your first eight weeks

1. **Go to office hours in week two**, before anything is wrong. Introduce yourself. That is the whole visit.
2. **Open a GitHub account this week.** Every piece of work you make goes in it. In two years it beats a resume.
3. **Join the Computer Science Club.** Those people become your study group first and your network later.
4. **Pick one certification target** and keep it in view. CompTIA A+ is the usual first one.
5. **Keep a file of what you built** and one sentence on why you built it that way. You will need it at your first interview.

Jorge Vega Faculty, Computer and Information Technology Jorge.Vega@phoenixcollege.edu	Will Tagart Program Director, Information Technology and Cybersecurity Will.Tagart@phoenixcollege.edu	Brad Olsen Program Director, Bachelor of Applied Science in IT Brad.Olsen@phoenixcollege.edu
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IT Institute at Phoenix College, phoenixcollege.edu/ITI · Course sequence, learning outcomes, and wage figures are from the Maricopa Bachelor of Applied Science in Information Technology pathway map. Program details change between catalog years, so confirm your plan with an academic advisor.